into existence out of the basic needs of life. It continues to remain for the sake of good life. The aims, desires, and aspirations of human beings are translated into action through the State. Though the State is a necessary institution, no two writers agree on its definition. This disagreement makes the study of the State more creative and interesting. For instance, we have social Contract theory in political science. The three main thinkers associated with social contract theory are ***Thomas Hobbes***, ***John Locke*** and ***Jean Jacques Rousseau***. The three thinkers collectively agree that humans need to be controlled by the State. At the same time, they disagree on to what extent the control can be exercised by the State on humans.

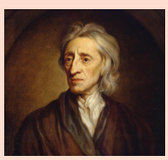
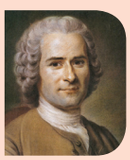


Political Thinkers	Human Nature	State of Nature	Social contract
Hobbes	Man is a wolf unto his fellow man	A state of war	Leviathan
Locke	Man has perfect freedom	Property is not secure	Common wealth
Rousseau	Man is free but immoral	No security or morality	State guided by the general will

ACTIVITY

Find Me....

The social Contract Theory of the State was put forth by the three main proponents collectively called contractualists. The three agreed that humans need to be controlled by the State. But to what extent that control should be has been debated in their unique way. Find out who the three are?

2.2 Essential Elements of State

The state is a set of institutions which has an unquestionable authority over people. Hence all modern States have their own Constitution that moderates the freedom and privileges of the citizens of the State with the coercive and unquestionable power of the State. Hence Constitution is considered as a limiting agent on the overwhelming authority of the State.

The ***Montevideo*** Convention on Rights and Duties of States held in 1933 gave the fundamental understanding of State. A State must have a permanent population, a defined territory and a government that can control the territory and its people and conducts international

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